

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System	))))	Docket No. RM26-4-000
---	------------------	------------------------------

REPLY COMMENTS OF SWITCH, LTD.

Switch, Ltd. (“Switch”) respectfully submits these reply comments in response to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (“FERC” or the “Commission”) request for comments in the above-referenced proceeding on the Secretary of Energy’s proposed advance notice of proposed rulemaking (“proposed ANOPR”) to the Commission with respect to the interconnection of large loads to the interstate transmission system.¹ Switch is a premier provider of AI, cloud and enterprise data centers. As a data center developer and operator, Switch appreciates the Commission’s leadership in addressing the interconnection of large loads, including data centers, to the interstate transmission system. Switch generally supports FERC’s effort to develop standardized, transparent, and non-discriminatory procedures tailored to large load interconnections such as data centers. Timely and non-discriminatory access to the transmission system is essential to reliability, economic growth, and national competitiveness.

¹ See *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Docket No. RM26-4-000, Notice Inviting Comments (issued Oct. 27, 2025); *Secretary of Energy’s Direction that the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission Initiate Rulemaking Procedures and Proposal Regarding the Interconnection of Large Loads Pursuant to the Secretary’s Authority Under Section 403 of the Department of Energy Organization Act*, Dep’t of Energy (Oct. 23, 2025), available at <https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2025-10/403%20Large%20Loads%20Letter.pdf>.

I. Comments on the Proposed ANOPR

We are facing a critical juncture in our nation’s history to secure energy dominance and win the artificial intelligence and data race, which includes connecting and powering data centers as quickly as possible. Data centers are foundational to the modern economy and support essential services across nearly every sector. Data center operators like Switch are making substantial infrastructure investments across the United States.

Data center development can enhance both the reliability of the grid and affordability for ratepayers by increasing grid infrastructure investment and spreading the fixed costs of the power system over more users. For example, recent studies have found that load growth has tended to reduce retail electricity prices in recent years.²

As Secretary Wright noted, driving American AI innovation will require unprecedented and extraordinary quantities of electricity and substantial investment in the interstate transmission system, which must be done in an efficient, fair, and expeditious manner. We commend Secretary Wright and the Commission for recognizing the growing need for a standardized, transparent, and efficient process for large load interconnections. This proceeding has the potential to break new ground on rules and regulations that govern how data centers and other large loads interconnect to the electric grid. Those rules and regulations will go a long way toward determining whether the United States can develop the data centers necessary to serve its

² See, e.g., Wiser, O’Shaughnessy, Barbose, Cappers & Gorman, “Factors Influencing Recent Trends in Retail Electricity Prices in the United States,” 38 *The Electricity Journal* 107516 at 5-6 (Oct. 2025), *available at* <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tej.2025.107516> (“Contrary to these concerns, our analysis finds that state-level load growth in recent years (through 2024) has tended to reduce average retail electricity prices. . . . This finding aligns with the understanding that a primary driver of increased electricity-sector costs in recent years has been distribution and transmission expenditures—often devoted to refurbishment or replacement of existing infrastructure rather than to serve new loads. Spreading these fixed costs over more demand naturally exerts downward pressure on retail prices.”).

economic and national security interests, and do so at the speed necessary to compete—and win—in the global AI race.

Switch generally emphasizes the Data Center Coalition (“DCC”) initial comments supporting FERC’s attention and a clear, workable framework for large load interconnection.³ Current practices vary widely across regions, which can create uncertainty and delays that hinder investment by providing discriminatory access for the interconnection of large loads to the interstate transmission system. Current interconnection processes can take significantly longer than data center project development timelines.

If the Commission goes forward with the proposed ANOPR, it should focus on expediting interconnection of proven large load projects with demonstrated site control, committed customers, applicable permits, executed service agreements and/or project financing. This approach is consistent with the fourth principle for reform in the proposed ANOPR about standardized study deposits, readiness requirements, withdrawal penalties and other commitments and financial penalties to deter speculative projects. Any rules adopted by the Commission should prioritize projects that are ready for interconnection and reduce the incentives for speculative, non-viable projects. As part of this process, the Commission should consider firm timelines for studies and approvals for such projects that are ready for interconnection, similar to generator interconnection reforms under Order No. 2023.

The Commission should also focus on transparency and coordination for large load interconnection. The current process often lacks transparency into load interconnection queues and the study process. Switch encourages coordination between transmission providers and regional planning entities to avoid duplicative studies and delays. If the Commission decides to

³ See *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Docket No. RM26-4-000, Comments of the Data Center Coalition (filed Nov. 21, 2025).

proceed with the proposed ANOPR, it should require transmission providers to publish queue status, study assumptions, and cost estimates for large load interconnections.

II. Conclusion

Switch respectfully requests that the Commission consider these comments and looks forward to working with the Commission and industry stakeholders in addressing these issues.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/
Alise Porto
SVP of Energy and Sustainability
Switch, Ltd.
Regulatory@switch.com